

# THE WOUNDED ANGEL

2026

I had an interesting walk tonight. Just as I thought the walk was over - at 2:20am - I spotted a comically small black pleated skirt swaying in front of me. All the bars are closed. There's no one else in eyesight.

My brain instantly clocked an uncanny resemblance between this girl and the girl Natalie showed me in *Unfinished Business* (the final chapter of *Liber Umbrae* where I channel her spirit) when she intentionally mishears "Pleiades" as "pleats". So, one could start to think that perhaps Natalie somehow caused this encounter.

However, to do so, one would be ignoring the stark fact that there are approximately 40,000 girls in tiny, pleated skirts on 6th Street on any given night. Ergo, the raw probability falls strongly in favor of coincidence.

So, I catch up to her with a relatively self-aware, "Nevermind the weird guy creeping up on you in the middle of the night."

She maintained her pace, looked me in the eyes and said, "You didn't scare me..."

A+ response.

I look her up and down and she was an alt girl. Not what I was expecting given the view. But I'm not complaining either.

"How was your evening?"

"Uneventful. You?"

"I used the flashlight on my phone to assist a random shirtless twink find his keys in the grass."

"Did he find them?"

"No. He remembered that he didn't own a car!"

Being one to rapidly dispense with small talk, I pivoted with, "Which kind of weirdo are you?"

She replied, "I don't know, but I'm definitely a weirdo."

...we have achieved full engagement!

"I just got broken up with a week ago. It's really been difficult."

OK, this can't possibly get any easier...

So we exchanged names. Hers may or may not be Clarissa.

She's bartender, which explains a lot about the lack of fear and 2:20am sobriety.

She continued. "What kind of weirdo are you?"

I replied, "I'm an author."

"Author of what?"

"Occult books."

"What are they about?"

"The first one is about how to be a good person. The second is about how to perceive reality as it truly is."

She gets visibly excited by this.

"That's exactly what I need right now!"

This couldn't be made simpler if I'd written this interaction myself!

She's on her way to an afterhours club to meet her gay best friend Max. She asks if I have plans. Why, no, I happen to be available.

Max is waiting for us at the next intersection.

So, all three of us go to this club. They're doing pat-downs at the door. I had a small folding knife on me. I observe the pat down procedure and slip the knife into my sock when they aren't looking.

Mental Note: Remember to tell headquarters that I have breached the perimeter!

...and then there's a \$20 cover charge.

"Well, that was fun... I'll just be off."

Max comes in with, "No, man, I got you. If Clarissa says you're cool I'll cover you."

We go to the illegal cash bar. My broke ass is looking awkward. Max asks what I want. He reiterates that he's got me.

Just as a reminder, I just met this guy 10 minutes prior!

Then an interesting thing happens. He pays for my drink and she pays for hers and his. OK... apparently, there's some kind of underground economic etiquette that no one told me about.

So now we're in a fucking club environment. Not ideal.

We wander. There's a karaoke room because of course there is. Things have just gotten awkward. I'm stone-sober with half a beer in my hand. I am not equipped for karaoke.

We located a bench to sit on and observe the drunken revelry. Clarissa finds an excuse to sit very close to me.

I revealed that I've authored more than 100 essays on the subject of relationships and dating.

"So you're a pick-up artist?"

ROFL

"Hardly. But it's interesting that you mention that because I do write some essays intended to appeal to that crowd only to bait-and-switch them with a guide to ethical behavior, agency, and consent." (reference: *How To Sleep With a Woman The Night You Meet Her*)

I continued, "The truly fascinating thing is that my techniques are not only ethical, but they have also been proven to be highly effective at attracting women! The point, of course, is that there is no need for games in order for humans to get what they want from one another. But I also have a whole long thing examining why they do anyway." (reference: *Boys are from Room 103; Girls are from Room 104*)

Then, we pivoted sharply to the story about the Austin Vampire Court being founded in my kitchen and how I hosted all their parties for 4 years.

Then she asks me, "You mean like REAL vampires?"

OK. So she's not an intellectual titan. But it's truly unnerving the number of times I have had to remind people that vampires don't physically exist.

This led up to the story of the time MTV showed up at my house to film an episode of True Life. (reference: MTV True Life: "I Want Respect For My Sect")

"I'm going to check that out."

"It may be difficult because of how MTV is about their media. But I can send the video to you."

I was both being totally honest and also being slick about getting her contact details. She, oddly, was not forthcoming though.

So we continue on bantering like this for about 30 minutes, then she starts obsessively checking her phone. She just occasionally looks up with an "I'm sorry." expression. The person texting her was her ex, obviously, whom she felt compelled to respond to.

This goes on for like an hour. Then she suddenly jumped up and bolted out the door. She gave me zero signal to pursue.

About a minute later, Max asked me where she went. I said that her ex has been texting her. He replied, "She's really going through it." Then, he left. I gave him 5 minutes to make a clean break. Then, I left.

She and I exchanged names, but I didn't get her number.

All in all, it was a far more entertaining evening than expected. As per protocol, my expectations were calibrated precisely at zero. Therefore, the evening exceeded my expectations. So we'll call it a win!

## HINDSIGHT

1. Max was likely motivated to cover me for a couple of reasons:

- a. Clarissa had indicated to him nonverbally that I passed the vibe check of a Sixth Street bartender.
- b. He observed that Clarissa seemed happy around me and he cares about her and wanted to see that continue.

2. Selecting "Lucid Dreams" by Juice WRLD for karaoke might have been strong enough to change the outcome of the evening... especially if she saw the tears roll down my cheek as I clumsily attempted to sing it. (Because the song is about a breakup with a girl with BPD which ties it back to Natalie). However, at that time, I believed the evening to be going extremely well and was in a simple "just don't fuck this up" mindset. I had no way to know that the ghost of penis past would enter the chat (literally) only minutes later.

3. The story is structurally recursive.

The story of Clarissa almost perfectly mirrored the story about helping the guy find keys to a car that didn't exist. Here's how the symbolism maps:

guy -> Clarissa

flashlight -> Author of how to see truth

keys -> emotions

car -> old relationship

search -> escape

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## HYPOTHETICAL

The previous section is a work of nonfiction. All of that occurred. The following is purely a hypothetical scenario intended to demonstrate the resolution proposed in Room 103/104 applied to this scenario.

The next day, I went for my nightly walk as usual. And sure enough, there she was. We locked eyes momentarily and I could see an expression of fear on her face as she turned to run. Being only a few feet away, I quickly caught her. Yes,

I physically restrained her momentarily. She looked at me with a more intense expression of fear and I just smiled at her and said, "You don't owe me anything." <pause> "How are you doing?"

She ran because she had been conditioned by other men that when she exercises her agency in a way that causes a disappointing result, men will become angry and perhaps even try to exact revenge. So, she ran not out of embarrassment or because she felt like she even had anything to apologize for. She ran because her script tells her, "I just poked a bear."

Physically restraining her was a risky move because it assumes that my premise is correct. While it was impossible to know that with certainty, all interpersonal interactions are matters of statistics and the statistical weights were HEAVILY in favor of my interpretation. But even so, does that justify physical intervention? Yes, for two reasons:

1. The purpose of the intervention was to both benefit her and to diffuse the perceived need to flee.
2. I had her for 3 seconds just to say the critical sentence and then she was free to go.

This is also not a case of "man exerts physical dominance of woman" either. This scenario can and does happen in reverse.

The key takeaway though is that when I said "You don't owe me anything" that was the moment I spoke to her inner wounded 6-year-old and healed the damage from the playground all those years ago.